

Euro 2028 Predictor — Candidate Team Pool and Draw Slot Assignment Brief

Purpose

This document records a proposed update to the Euro 2028 Predictor data/admin model.

The goal is to replace random/fake tester teams with a realistic **candidate team pool** that can later be assigned to official tournament draw slots after the real Euro 2028 draw.

This should make testing more realistic, make the admin setup easier, and future-proof the app for later tournaments.

Current problem

The current tournament structure correctly uses provisional draw slots because the real Euro 2028 teams and draw are not known yet.

Examples:

A1, A2, A3, A4
B1, B2, B3, B4
C1, C2, C3, C4
D1, D2, D3, D4
E1, E2, E3, E4
F1, F2, F3, F4

This is correct and should remain the official tournament structure until the draw is known.

However, for testing and admin setup, using only generic placeholders or random tester teams makes the app feel less realistic and makes visual testing weaker.

Proposed solution

Create a separate **candidate team pool**.

This is a list of realistic likely/eligible UEFA teams that can be used for staging, testing, admin selection and future draw assignment.

The key rule is:

Tournament slots and real team identities must stay separate.

The official competition structure remains slot-based until teams are officially assigned.

The candidate team pool simply gives Admin a realistic list of teams to assign to those slots later.

Core model

Separate these concepts:

Concept	Meaning
Tournament	Euro 2028
Draw slot	Official group position such as A1, A2, B3, F4
Candidate team	A real team that may qualify or be useful for testing
Slot assignment	Admin assigns a candidate/qualified team to an official draw slot
Fixture	Continues to use the slot structure, but displays assigned teams where available

Example after the draw:

A1 = Scotland
A2 = Germany
A3 = Hungary
A4 = Switzerland

Once assigned, the app should display those teams wherever the slots appear.

Why this is useful

A candidate team pool would improve:

- realistic testing;
- flag testing;
- long team-name layout testing;
- Groups page realism;
- Home dashboard realism;
- Match Centre realism;
- Bracket visual testing;
- Review Picks testing;
- Prediction Trends testing;
- Team Profile testing;
- admin draw setup after the real tournament draw;

- future tournament reuse.

This is better than randomly seeding fake teams because the app can be tested with names and flags that feel close to the final product.

Public-facing rule

Candidate teams must not be presented publicly as confirmed Euro 2028 teams before they are officially qualified and drawn.

Before official assignment, public UI should still use calm placeholder language such as:

- Team TBC;
- Qualifying slot;
- Participants TBC;
- Draw position TBC.

The candidate pool is for staging/admin/testing unless explicitly approved for public display.

Suggested candidate team statuses

Candidate teams may need statuses.

Suggested statuses:

Status	Meaning
candidate	Team is in the pool for testing/admin selection
qualified	Team is confirmed qualified but not assigned to a draw slot
assigned	Team is assigned to an official Euro 2028 slot
eliminated	Team is no longer eligible / did not qualify
archived	Retained for history or future tournaments

Not all statuses need to be implemented immediately if the existing schema already supports a simpler version.

Suggested initial candidate team pool

Use this as the initial realistic Euro 2028 testing/admin pool:

Albania
Austria
Belgium

Bosnia and Herzegovina
Croatia
Czech Republic
Denmark
England
Finland
France
Georgia
Germany
Greece
Hungary
Iceland
Israel
Italy
Kosovo
Netherlands
Norway
Poland
Portugal
Republic of Ireland
Romania
Scotland
Serbia
Slovakia
Slovenia
Spain
Sweden
Switzerland
Turkey
Ukraine
Wales
Northern Ireland

Notes:

- Normalise `N.Ireland` to `Northern Ireland`.
- A short display version such as `N. Ireland` may be used in tight UI if needed.
- The list is for realistic testing/admin use only.
- It should not be described publicly as a confirmed qualifier list.

Admin assignment workflow

Admin should eventually be able to assign teams to slots.

Suggested Admin section:

Tournament Team Assignments

Example table:

Slot	Current team	Action
A1	TBC	Assign team
A2	TBC	Assign team
A3	TBC	Assign team
A4	TBC	Assign team

Admin should be able to:

- assign a team to a slot;
- clear a slot;
- change an assignment before lock/draw finalisation;
- see duplicate assignment warnings;
- mark the assignment set as official/final when appropriate;
- avoid accidental public claims before assignment is official.

Where assigned teams should flow

Once a team is assigned to a slot, the display should flow through:

- Groups;
- fixtures;
- Home;
- Results;
- Match Centre;
- Original Bracket;
- KO Predictor where relevant;
- Team Profile;
- Review Picks;
- Prediction Trends;
- Leagues;
- Leaderboards where team labels are shown;
- share/export surfaces if any.

Safety rules

This feature must be implemented safely.

1. Slot identity must remain stable

Predictions should remain tied to the proper fixture/slot structure.

Assigning Scotland to A1 should update display identity, but it must not corrupt the underlying prediction structure.

2. Assignment must not rewrite user predictions

Changing a slot assignment should not delete, rewrite or corrupt user scores, jokers, bracket picks or Review state.

3. Prevent duplicate active assignments

The same team should not be assigned to two active Euro 2028 slots at the same time.

4. Public UI must not imply confirmation too early

Candidate teams are not official participants until qualification/draw assignment is confirmed.

5. Post-lock changes must be controlled

After the Original Predictor lock, assignment changes should be tightly controlled and admin-only.

6. No migration unless truly needed

Do not create Migration 019 unless a genuine schema/read-contract gap is proved and explicitly approved.

If the current schema can support this through existing team/participant/slot structures, prefer using the existing model.

Testing benefits

This feature would allow realistic staging tests for:

- all group fixtures;
- long team names, e.g. Bosnia and Herzegovina;
- short names, e.g. Spain;
- local flag rendering;
- bracket layout;
- mobile overflow;
- Home match cards;
- Match Centre headers;
- Results rows;
- Review completion;
- Prediction Trends aggregates;

- Team Profile sheets.

Future-proofing

This model should support later tournaments.

The future-proof structure is:

```
Tournament
→ Tournament slots
→ Candidate/qualified teams
→ Official slot assignments
```

This avoids hardcoding team names directly into fixtures and makes future tournament setup easier.

Implementation guidance

Treat this as a controlled staging/admin data feature.

Do not simply replace all provisional slots with hardcoded teams.

Do not randomly seed fake teams if a realistic candidate pool is available.

Do not expose the candidate pool publicly as official Euro 2028 participants.

Do not revive old legacy team/test-data assumptions without checking the active Euro data model.

Recommended stage name

Suggested stage name:

```
STAGE-CANDIDATE-TEAM-POOL-1
```

Recommended scope for first pass

The first pass should be small and safe:

1. Inspect current schema/source to confirm how teams, participants and slots are represented.
2. Confirm whether a candidate team pool can be added without Migration 019.
3. Add or document the candidate team pool in the safest existing place.
4. Keep official draw slots unchanged.
5. Add/admin-document a future assignment workflow.
6. Ensure no user predictions are rewritten by assignment.

7. Ensure public UI still treats unassigned participants as TBC/provisional.
8. Run existing gates.

Acceptance criteria

This stage is acceptable only if:

- official draw slots remain stable;
- candidate teams are separate from official slot assignments;
- public UI does not claim candidate teams are confirmed;
- assigned teams flow through the app only where assignment is deliberate;
- no duplicate active slot assignment is possible or at least the risk is clearly documented;
- no predictions are overwritten;
- no Original/KO scoring logic changes;
- no resolver logic changes unless separately approved;
- no Supabase schema migration unless explicitly approved;
- WC26 production remains untouched.

Summary

The candidate team pool is a good idea.

It gives the app realistic teams for staging and admin setup while preserving the correct provisional slot structure.

The right model is:

```
Keep A1-F4 as the official tournament slots.  
Create a realistic candidate team pool.  
Allow Admin to assign candidate/qualified teams to slots after the real draw.  
Keep public UI provisional until assignment is official.
```

This should make the app easier to test, easier to set up after the draw, and easier to reuse for future tournaments.